

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Regional Development and Five Year Plans - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Regional Development and Five Year Plans - Solved Practice Workbook 5

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 5

Q1. Which statement correctly explains Regional development meaning?	5
Q2. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Regional development meaning?	5
Q3. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Regional development meaning?	5
Q4. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Regional development meaning?	5
Q5. Which statement correctly explains Regional planning unit?	6
Q6. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Regional planning unit?	6
Q7. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Regional planning unit?	6
Q8. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Regional planning unit?	6
Q9. Which statement correctly explains Uneven development drivers?	6
Q10. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Uneven development drivers?	7
Q11. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Uneven development drivers?	7
Q12. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Uneven development drivers?	7
Q13. Which statement correctly explains Perroux growth pole idea?	7
Q14. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Perroux growth pole idea?	7
Q15. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Perroux growth pole idea?	8
Q16. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Perroux growth pole idea?	8
Q17. Which statement correctly explains Friedmann core-periphery logic?	8
Q18. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Friedmann core-periphery logic?	8
Q19. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Friedmann core-periphery logic?	8
Q20. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Friedmann core-periphery logic?	9
Q21. Which statement correctly explains Myrdal spread and backwash?	9
Q22. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Myrdal spread and backwash?	9
Q23. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Myrdal spread and backwash?	9
Q24. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Myrdal spread and backwash?	9
Q25. Which statement correctly explains Balanced-unbalanced growth debate?	10
Q26. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Balanced-unbalanced growth debate?	10
Q27. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Balanced-unbalanced growth debate?	10

Q28. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Balanced-unbalanced growth debate?	10
Q29. Which statement correctly explains Planning region criteria?	10
Q30. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Planning region criteria?	11
Q31. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Planning region criteria?	11
Q32. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Planning region criteria?	11
Q33. Which statement correctly explains Disparity versus diversity?	11
Q34. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Disparity versus diversity?	11
Q35. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Disparity versus diversity?	12
Q36. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Disparity versus diversity?	12
Q37. Which statement correctly explains National Planning Committee 1938?	12
Q38. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of National Planning Committee 1938?	12
Q39. Which statement preserves the process boundary for National Planning Committee 1938?	12
Q40. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning National Planning Committee 1938?	13
Q41. Which statement correctly explains Planning Commission and First Plan?	13
Q42. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Planning Commission and First Plan?	13
Q43. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Planning Commission and First Plan?	13
Q44. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Planning Commission and First Plan?	13
Q45. Which statement correctly explains First Plan priorities?	14
Q46. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of First Plan priorities?	14
Q47. Which statement preserves the process boundary for First Plan priorities?	14
Q48. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning First Plan priorities?	14
Q49. Which statement correctly explains Second Plan heavy industry?	14
Q50. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Second Plan heavy industry?	15
Q51. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Second Plan heavy industry?	15
Q52. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Second Plan heavy industry?	15
Q53. Which statement correctly explains Annual Plans and last cycle?	15
Q54. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Annual Plans and last cycle?	15
Q55. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Annual Plans and last cycle?	16
Q56. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Annual Plans and last cycle?	16
Q57. Which statement correctly explains Balanced development remained incomplete?	16
Q58. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Balanced development remained incomplete?	16
Q59. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Balanced development remained incomplete?	16

Q60. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Balanced development remained incomplete?	17
Q61. Which statement correctly explains NITI replacement date?	17
Q62. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of NITI replacement date?	17
Q63. Which statement preserves the process boundary for NITI replacement date?	17
Q64. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning NITI replacement date?	17
Q65. Which statement correctly explains NITI planning style?	18
Q66. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of NITI planning style?	18
Q67. Which statement preserves the process boundary for NITI planning style?	18
Q68. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning NITI planning style?	18
Q69. Which statement correctly explains Aspirational Districts?	19
Q70. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Aspirational Districts?	19
Q71. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Aspirational Districts?	19
Q72. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Aspirational Districts?	19
Q73. Which statement correctly explains SDG India Index 2023-24?	19
Q74. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of SDG India Index 2023-24?	20
Q75. Which statement preserves the process boundary for SDG India Index 2023-24?	20
Q76. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning SDG India Index 2023-24?	20
Q77. Which statement correctly explains District and block targeting?	20
Q78. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of District and block targeting?	20
Q79. Which statement preserves the process boundary for District and block targeting?	21
Q80. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning District and block targeting?	21

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE 21

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT	21
PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I	21
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	22
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	23
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	24
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	25
ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS	26
ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS	27

Regional Development and Five Year Plans - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly explains Regional development meaning?

A. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. B. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. C. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. D. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development.

Answer: A. Explanation: Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q2. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Regional development meaning?

A. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. B. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. C. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. D. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development.

Answer: B. Explanation: Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q3. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Regional development meaning?

A. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. B. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. C. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. D. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Regional development meaning?

A. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. B. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. C. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. D. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit.

Answer: D. Explanation: Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly explains Regional planning unit?

A. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. B. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. C. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. D. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development.

Answer: A. Explanation: Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q6. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Regional planning unit?

A. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. B. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. C. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. D. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery.

Answer: B. Explanation: Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q7. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Regional planning unit?

A. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. B. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. C. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. D. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery.

Answer: C. Explanation: Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Regional planning unit?

A. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. B. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. C. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. D. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole.

Answer: D. Explanation: Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly explains Uneven development drivers?

A. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. B. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. C. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. D. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages.

Answer: A. Explanation: Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q10. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Uneven development drivers?

A. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. B. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. C. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. D. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes.

Answer: B. Explanation: Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q11. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Uneven development drivers?

A. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. B. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. C. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. D. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Uneven development drivers?

A. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. B. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. C. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. D. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development.

Answer: D. Explanation: Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly explains Perroux growth pole idea?

A. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. B. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. C. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. D. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes.

Answer: A. Explanation: Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q14. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Perroux growth pole idea?

A. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. B. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. C. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. D. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. The other options describe different processes,

locations, scales or governance categories.

Q15. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Perroux growth pole idea?

A. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. B. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. C. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. D. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure.

Answer: C. Explanation: Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Perroux growth pole idea?

A. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. B. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. C. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. D. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages.

Answer: D. Explanation: Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly explains Friedmann core-periphery logic?

A. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. B. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. C. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. D. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q18. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Friedmann core-periphery logic?

A. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. B. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. C. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. D. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability.

Answer: B. Explanation: Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q19. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Friedmann core-periphery logic?

A. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. B. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. C. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. D. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure.

Answer: C. Explanation: Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Friedmann core-periphery logic?

A. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. B. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. C. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. D. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery.

Answer: D. Explanation: Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly explains Myrdal spread and backwash?

A. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. B. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. C. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. D. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability.

Answer: A. Explanation: Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q22. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Myrdal spread and backwash?

A. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. B. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. C. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. D. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure.

Answer: B. Explanation: Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q23. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Myrdal spread and backwash?

A. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. B. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. C. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. D. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938.

Answer: C. Explanation: Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Myrdal spread and backwash?

A. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. B. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. C. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. D. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions.

Answer: D. Explanation: Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly explains Balanced-unbalanced growth debate?

A. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. B. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. C. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. D. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938.

Answer: A. Explanation: The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q26. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Balanced-unbalanced growth debate?

A. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. B. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. C. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. D. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938.

Answer: B. Explanation: The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q27. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Balanced-unbalanced growth debate?

A. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. B. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. C. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. D. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51.

Answer: C. Explanation: The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Balanced-unbalanced growth debate?

A. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. B. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. C. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. D. The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes.

Answer: D. Explanation: The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly explains Planning region criteria?

A. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. B. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. C. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. D. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure.

Answer: A. Explanation: A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q30. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Planning region criteria?

A. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. B. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. C. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. D. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking.

Answer: B. Explanation: A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q31. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Planning region criteria?

A. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. B. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. C. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. D. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51.

Answer: C. Explanation: A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Planning region criteria?

A. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. B. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. C. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. D. A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability.

Answer: D. Explanation: A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly explains Disparity versus diversity?

A. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. B. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. C. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. D. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51.

Answer: A. Explanation: Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q34. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Disparity versus diversity?

A. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. B. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. C. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. D. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51.

Answer: B. Explanation: Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q35. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Disparity versus diversity?

A. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. B. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. C. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. D. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking.

Answer: C. Explanation: Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Disparity versus diversity?

A. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. B. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. C. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. D. Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure.

Answer: D. Explanation: Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly explains National Planning Committee 1938?

A. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. B. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. C. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. D. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking.

Answer: A. Explanation: Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q38. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of National Planning Committee 1938?

A. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. B. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. C. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. D. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle.

Answer: B. Explanation: Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q39. Which statement preserves the process boundary for National Planning Committee 1938?

A. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. B. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. C. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. D. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base.

Answer: C. Explanation: Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning National Planning Committee 1938?

A. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. B. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. C. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. D. Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938.

Answer: D. Explanation: Khullar traces Indian planning back to the National Planning Committee of 1938. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly explains Planning Commission and First Plan?

A. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. B. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. C. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. D. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q42. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Planning Commission and First Plan?

A. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. B. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. C. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. D. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q43. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Planning Commission and First Plan?

A. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. B. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. C. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. D. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Planning Commission and First Plan?

A. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. B. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. C. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. D. The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly explains First Plan priorities?

A. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. B. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. C. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. D. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle.

Answer: A. Explanation: The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q46. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of First Plan priorities?

A. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. B. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. C. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. D. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era.

Answer: B. Explanation: The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q47. Which statement preserves the process boundary for First Plan priorities?

A. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. B. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. C. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. D. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015.

Answer: C. Explanation: The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning First Plan priorities?

A. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. B. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. C. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. D. The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking.

Answer: D. Explanation: The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly explains Second Plan heavy industry?

A. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. B. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. C. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. D. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q50. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Second Plan heavy industry?

A. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. B. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. C. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. D. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q51. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Second Plan heavy industry?

A. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. B. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. C. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. D. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Second Plan heavy industry?

A. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. B. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. C. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. D. The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly explains Annual Plans and last cycle?

A. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. B. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. C. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. D. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone.

Answer: A. Explanation: India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q54. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Annual Plans and last cycle?

A. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. B. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. C. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. D. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts.

Answer: B. Explanation: India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q55. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Annual Plans and last cycle?

A. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. B. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. C. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. D. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts.

Answer: C. Explanation: India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Annual Plans and last cycle?

A. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. B. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. C. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. D. India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle.

Answer: D. Explanation: India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly explains Balanced development remained incomplete?

A. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. B. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. C. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. D. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone.

Answer: A. Explanation: Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q58. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Balanced development remained incomplete?

A. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. B. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. C. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. D. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators.

Answer: B. Explanation: Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q59. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Balanced development remained incomplete?

A. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. B. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. C. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. D. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts.

Answer: C. Explanation: Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Balanced development remained incomplete?

A. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. B. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. C. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. D. Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era.

Answer: D. Explanation: Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly explains NITI replacement date?

A. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. B. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. C. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. D. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q62. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of NITI replacement date?

A. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. B. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. C. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. D. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q63. Which statement preserves the process boundary for NITI replacement date?

A. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. B. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. C. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. D. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning NITI replacement date?

A. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. B. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. C. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. D. The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly explains NITI planning style?

A. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. B. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. C. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. D. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts.

Answer: A. Explanation: The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q66. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of NITI planning style?

A. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. B. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. C. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. D. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity.

Answer: B. Explanation: The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q67. Which statement preserves the process boundary for NITI planning style?

A. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. B. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. C. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. D. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole.

Answer: C. Explanation: The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning NITI planning style?

A. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. B. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. C. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. D. The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone.

Answer: D. Explanation: The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly explains Aspirational Districts?

A. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. B. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. C. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. D. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit.

Answer: A. Explanation: NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q70. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Aspirational Districts?

A. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. B. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. C. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. D. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole.

Answer: B. Explanation: NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q71. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Aspirational Districts?

A. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. B. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. C. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. D. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development.

Answer: C. Explanation: NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Aspirational Districts?

A. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. B. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. C. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. D. NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts.

Answer: D. Explanation: NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly explains SDG India Index 2023-24?

A. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. B. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. C. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. D. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit.

Answer: A. Explanation: The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q74. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of SDG India Index 2023-24?

A. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. B. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. C. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. D. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit.

Answer: B. Explanation: The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q75. Which statement preserves the process boundary for SDG India Index 2023-24?

A. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. B. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. C. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. D. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages.

Answer: C. Explanation: The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning SDG India Index 2023-24?

A. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. B. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. C. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. D. The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators.

Answer: D. Explanation: The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly explains District and block targeting?

A. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. B. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. C. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. D. Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit.

Answer: A. Explanation: Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q78. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of District and block targeting?

A. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. B. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. C. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. D. Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole.

Answer: B. Explanation: Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q79. Which statement preserves the process boundary for District and block targeting?

A. Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. B. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. C. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. D. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery.

Answer: C. Explanation: Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning District and block targeting?

A. Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. B. Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. C. Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. D. Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity.

Answer: D. Explanation: Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

This topic has a verified direct routed demand: the 2024 GS-I question asking what regional disparity is, how it differs from diversity and how serious it is in India. The package therefore keeps the disparity-diversity distinction explicit and does not fabricate any additional direct PYQ.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I

Demand: What is regional disparity? How does it differ from diversity? How serious is the issue of regional disparity in India?

Status: Verified direct PYQ routed inside the Advanced owner for Geography Topic 29.

Model solution: Regional disparity means ranked inequality among regions in income, productivity, infrastructure, literacy, health and opportunity, whereas regional diversity means unranked difference of character such as language, ecology or cropping pattern. India shows serious disparity because growth, irrigation, industry, services and governance capacity have clustered unevenly across states, districts and metropolitan corridors, and intra-state inequality often rivals interstate inequality. A balanced answer should therefore separate diversity from disparity, explain why markets and historical head starts concentrate development, and conclude that planning has changed in form but regional imbalance remains a first-order problem.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I", all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the human-geography demand in "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: What is regional disparity? How does it differ from diversity? How serious is the issue of regional disparity in India? **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Verified direct PYQ routed inside the Advanced owner for Geography Topic 29. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the human-geography demand in “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish regional disparity from regional diversity. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Diversity is unranked difference, while disparity is ranked inequality; the distinction matters because policy should protect diversity but reduce disparity.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit.
- Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole.
- Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure.

Qualified conclusion: Diversity is unranked difference, while disparity is ranked inequality; the distinction matters because policy should protect diversity but reduce disparity.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Distinguish regional disparity from regional diversity. Answer in about 150 words.”, all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Diversity is unranked difference, while disparity is ranked inequality; the distinction matters because policy should protect diversity but reduce disparity.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Regional development treats planning as the deliberate improvement of production, welfare, infrastructure and social capability in a defined territorial unit. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Regional planning applies development logic to a specific region rather than to the country as a whole. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Regional diversity means unranked difference of character, while regional disparity means ranked inequality of outcomes such as income, literacy, health or infrastructure. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: Diversity is unranked difference, while disparity is ranked inequality; the distinction matters because policy should protect diversity but reduce disparity.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish regional disparity from regional diversity. Answer in about 150 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why planning regions need more than mere contiguity. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: A planning region is viable only when functional, economic, administrative, ecological and social criteria align well enough for implementation.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability.

Qualified conclusion: A planning region is viable only when functional, economic, administrative, ecological and social criteria align well enough for implementation.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Explain why planning regions need more than mere contiguity. Answer in about 150 words.”, all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: A planning region is viable only when functional, economic, administrative, ecological and social criteria align well enough for implementation.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A planning region should combine functional unity, administrative manageability, economic viability, ecological balance and social acceptability. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: A planning region is viable only when functional, economic, administrative, ecological and social criteria align well enough for implementation.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the

scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For “Explain why planning regions need more than mere contiguity. Answer in about 150 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Use growth-pole, core-periphery and spread-backwash ideas to explain regional imbalance. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Regional imbalance persists because development clusters in propulsive nodes, dominant cores drain surrounding regions, and spread effects remain weaker than backwash in many settings.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development.
- Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages.
- Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery.
- Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions.
- The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes.

Qualified conclusion: Regional imbalance persists because development clusters in propulsive nodes, dominant cores drain surrounding regions, and spread effects remain weaker than backwash in many settings.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Use growth-pole, core-periphery and spread-backwash ideas to explain regional imbalance....”, all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Regional imbalance persists because development clusters in propulsive nodes, dominant cores drain surrounding regions, and spread effects remain weaker than backwash in many settings.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Perroux's growth-pole idea says development begins in propulsive nodes or industries and then diffuses outward through linkages. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Core-periphery logic explains how a strong core dominates and organises a weaker periphery. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** The balanced-versus-unbalanced growth debate asks whether development should be spread widely or strategically concentrated in selected nodes. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: Regional imbalance persists because development clusters in propulsive nodes, dominant cores drain surrounding regions, and spread effects remain weaker than backwash in many settings.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For “Use growth-pole, core-periphery and spread-backwash ideas to explain regional imbalance....”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Trace the major spatial priorities of India's First and Second Five Year Plans. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The First Plan stressed irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement and power, while the Second Plan shifted toward heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51.
- The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking.
- The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base.

Qualified conclusion: The First Plan stressed irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement and power, while the Second Plan shifted toward heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base.

Demand decoding: The directive **trace** requires a direct position on “Trace the major spatial priorities of India's First and Second Five Year Plans. Answer in...”, all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The First Plan stressed irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement and power, while the Second Plan shifted toward heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Planning Commission was set up in 1950 and the First Five Year Plan launched the centralised planning framework in 1950-51. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The First Plan prioritised irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power and early resource-region thinking. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Second Plan shifted emphasis towards heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control,

regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: The First Plan stressed irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement and power, while the Second Plan shifted toward heavy industry and the public-sector industrial base.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For “Trace the major spatial priorities of India's First and Second Five Year Plans. Answer in...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Why did balanced regional development remain an incomplete achievement in India despite successive plans? Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Regional disparity persisted because irrigation, industry, markets, connectivity and governance capacity remained uneven, so backwash forces often beat spread effects even under planned development.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development.
- Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions.
- Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era.
- Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity.

Qualified conclusion: Regional disparity persisted because irrigation, industry, markets, connectivity and governance capacity remained uneven, so backwash forces often beat spread effects even under planned development.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Why did balanced regional development remain an incomplete achievement in India despite...”, all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Regional disparity persisted because irrigation, industry, markets, connectivity and governance capacity remained uneven, so backwash forces often beat spread effects even under planned development.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Resource endowment, transport access, market size, state policy, technology and historical advantage all contribute to uneven regional development. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Myrdal's spread and backwash effects show that growth can either diffuse benefits outward or drain labour, capital and talent from surrounding regions. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the

scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Khullar explicitly treats the failure to achieve balanced regional development as a major shortcoming of the Five Year Plan era. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: Regional disparity persisted because irrigation, industry, markets, connectivity and governance capacity remained uneven, so backwash forces often beat spread effects even under planned development.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For “Why did balanced regional development remain an incomplete achievement in India despite...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Has India moved from planning by Five Year Plans to planning by dashboards? Analyse. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: India's planning style has changed from centralised plan documents to mission platforms, district dashboards and territorial benchmarking, but the core geographic problem of regional imbalance remains.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle.
- The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015.
- The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone.
- NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts.
- The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators.
- Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity.

Qualified conclusion: India's planning style has changed from centralised plan documents to mission platforms, district dashboards and territorial benchmarking, but the core geographic problem of regional imbalance remains.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on “Has India moved from planning by Five Year Plans to planning by dashboards? Analyse. Answer...”, all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: India's planning style has changed from centralised plan documents to mission platforms, district dashboards and territorial benchmarking, but the core geographic problem of regional imbalance remains.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** India moved to Annual Plans in 1966-69 after war, drought and macro stress, and the Twelfth Plan was the last Five Year Plan cycle. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The NITI era stresses think-tank coordination, cooperative and competitive federalism, dashboards and mission-mode monitoring rather than plan outlay alone. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** NITI Aayog launched the Aspirational Districts Programme in January 2018 for 112 districts. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The SDG India Index 2023-24 gave India an overall score of 71 and shows development benchmarking through territorial indicators. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Current planning geography pushes targeting downward from state averages to districts and blocks because intra-state disparity is often as serious as interstate disparity. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: India's planning style has changed from centralised plan documents to mission platforms, district dashboards and territorial benchmarking, but the core geographic problem of regional imbalance remains.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For "Has India moved from planning by Five Year Plans to planning by dashboards? Analyse. Answer...", replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.